

Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

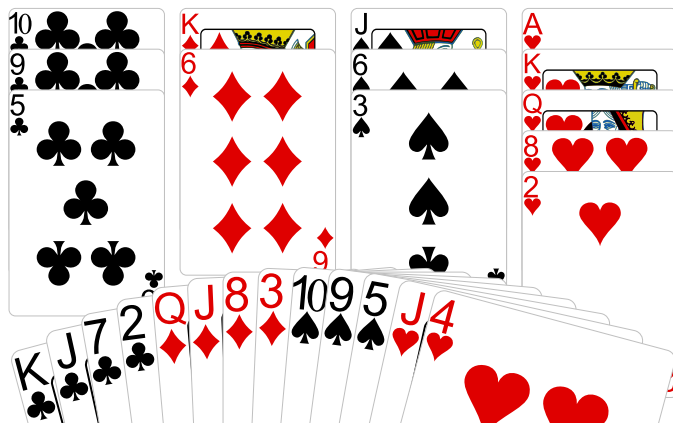
Keep in mind:

- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit

- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit

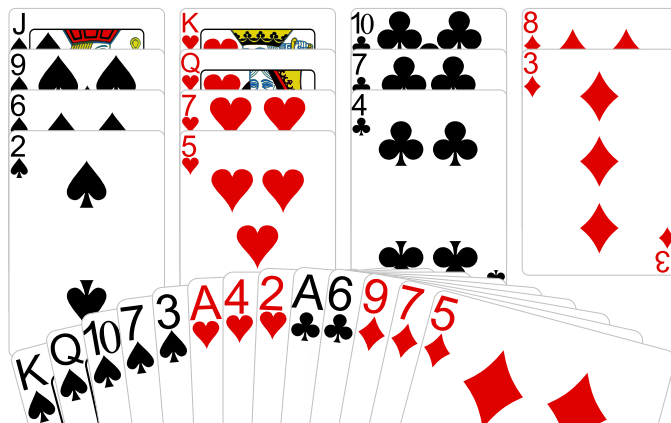
- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Deal 1 Ctr: 1NT Goal: at least ____ winners



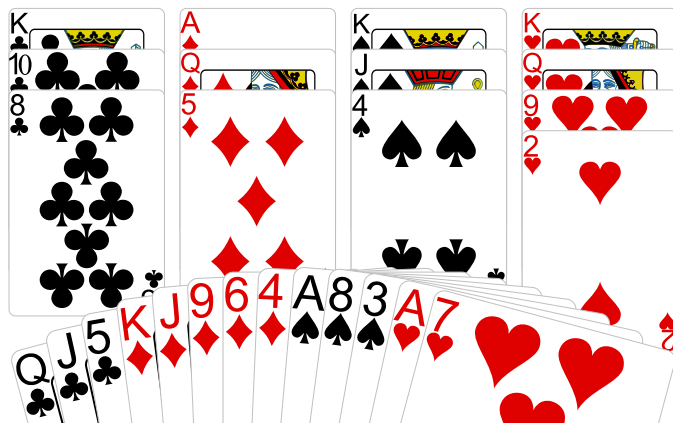
Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 2 Ctr: 2♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



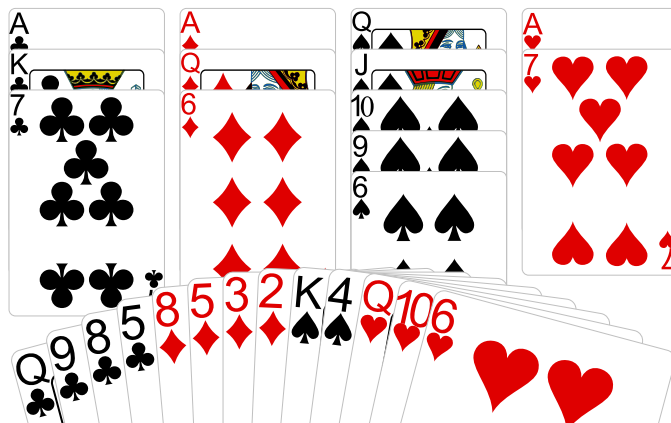
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 4 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 1NT

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2♠

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: West

Deal 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ K 8 7
♥ T 5 3
♦ A T 9 4 2
♣ Q 4

8
9 10
13

♠ T 9 5
♥ J 4
♦ Q J 8 3
♣ K J 7 2



♠ J 6 3
♥ A K Q 8 2
♦ K 6
♣ T 9 5

♠ A Q 4 2
♥ 9 7 6
♦ 7 5
♣ A 8 6 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT		1 ♥
All Pass			
1NT by North			

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SOUTH has a solid 1



opening, 14 points and five trumps.

NORTH must respond with 8 points, but cannot bid either minor suit since he needs at least

11 points to bid a new suit at the 2-level. So he bids 1NT (6-10 points).

SOUTH doesn't object to Notrump so she passes.

Deal 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 9 6 2
♥ K Q 7 5
♦ 8 3
♣ T 7 4

12
6 13
9

♠ A 5 4
♥ J T 9
♦ A Q 4 2
♣ J 5 2



♠ 8
♥ 8 6 3
♦ K J T 6
♣ K Q 9 8 3

♠ K Q T 7 3
♥ A 4 2
♦ 9 7 5
♣ A 6

West

North

East

South

2♠

All Pass

2♠ by East

the 11 points needed to bid a new suit at the 2-level.

1♠

Pass

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EAST has a normal 1♠ opening bid, 14 points and five trumps.

WEST has good 4-card support and 7 points, so she raises to 2♠,

passed by EAST.

WEST does not consider showing the



s,

first because she knows there is a ♠ fit, and second because she doesn't have

Deal 3

South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q 9 2
♥ T 8 5 3
♦ 8 3 2
♣ 9 7 3

18
2 5
15

♠ K J 4
♥ K Q 9 2
♦ A Q 5
♣ K T 8



♠ A 8 3
♥ A 7
♦ K J 9 6 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ T 7 6 5
♥ J 6 4
♦ T 7
♣ A 6 4 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	6NT		1NT
All Pass			
6NT by South			

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With balanced distribution and 16 points
SOUTH should open 1NT rather than 1

♦

NORTH's response is based on simple math.
He adds his 18 points to the 15 minimum that
SOUTH has announced and

comes up with 33 points combined. This is
enough for a small slam, and since he has
balanced distribution

he bids 6NT.

Deal 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 4
 ♥ Q T 6
 ♦ 8 5 3 2
 ♣ Q 9 8 5

8
 7 20
 5

♠ A 8 2
 ♥ K J 5 4 3 2
 ♦ 7 4
 ♣ T 3



♠ 7 5 3
 ♥ 9 8
 ♦ K J T 9
 ♣ J 6 4 2

♠ Q J T 9 6
 ♥ A 7
 ♦ A Q 6
 ♣ A K 7

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	1♠	Pass
All Pass		3NT	
3NT by West			

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EAST is right at the maximum for a 1♠ opening bid - one more point and he would

have opened 2♣.

WEST does not have 3-card ♠ support but with 7 points must make some response.

She cannot bid at the 2-level so she says 1NT (6-10 points).

EAST is fine with Notrump so he bids 3NT.